



INSPECTION TOOL FOR LICENSING A MORTUARY SERVICE

Assessment is by Observation, Interviewing, and Reviewing of Methods and Documents.

PRACTITIONER -IN-CHARGE: CERTIFIED PATHOLOGIST

GOVERNANCE, INFRASTRUCTURE, SAFETY AND SECURITY

a. STAFFING FOR AUTOPSY SERVICE

Technical Staff
1. Pathologist(s)/Medical Officer
2. Certified Embalmers (at least two)
3. Certified Autopsy Technician(s)/Assistants
4. Mortuary Porters
5. Mortuary Records Officer

STAFFING FOR COLD STORAGE

Technical Staff
1. Certified Embalmers (where applicable)
2. Cold storage porters/orderlies/cleaners/laundry attendant
3. Biomedical Engineer/ Access to a reputable Biomedical Engineering company
4. Others-specify:

STAFF ORGANIZATION

Staff clothing (Select at least 1 staff)	1. Availability
	2. Appropriate to function
Staff identification tags (select at least 1 staff)	3. Name of facility
	4. Name of staff
	5. Staff ID No.
	6. Photo ID
	7. Designation
	8. Clear & Legible
	9. Date of expiry

DOCUMENTATION

EPA Certificate
Local Authority Permit
Standard Operating Procedure
Duty Roster (with leave schedule)
Minutes of staff meetings (at least 3 recent ones)
Incident/accidents records book
Fault reporting and response log properly filled
Chain of custody policy/procedure
Fire certificate

MANAGEMENT INFORMATION SYSTEMS

Service Data	1. Reception/release registers as per guidelines
	2. System for ensuring confidentiality and data protection (refer policy on QA)
	3. Autopsy registration records
	4. Autopsy log book
	5. Storage register
	6. Records of Death Certificate/Burial permit/Transfer

OFFICE BUILDING

1. Pathologist's office	1a. Present
	1b. Adequate space
	1c. Adequate ventilation
	1d. Adequate lighting
2. Mortuary Service Manager's office	1a. Present
	1b. Adequate space
	1c. Adequate ventilation
	1d. Adequate lighting
3. Communication systems	Availability of notice boards (for public and staff at vantage areas)
	Official phone lines
	Records of communication with staff
	Display of official phone numbers of management to staff

SIGNAGE

1. Directional signs (Should be clear, boldly written and available to and within the facility)
2. Warning signs (No smoking, Danger, No Entry, Staff Only, etc.)
3. Emergency evacuation diagram clearly displayed at vantage areas
4. Entrances and exits are clearly labelled
5. Hazard/safety signage on entrances and exits clearly visible

EQUIPMENT AND ASSETS MAINTENANCE

Maintenance schedule	1. Availability of updated inventory
	2. Availability of Planned Preventive Maintenance schedule; in house or outsourced or both (availability, dates of next servicing and types of equipment indicated)
	3. The number of equipment with maintenance schedule
	4. Records of maintenance available and or displayed
	5. Availability of appropriate storage space for facility supplies (shelves, good ventilation and illumination)
	6. Fault reporting and response log properly filled
	7. Evidence of Equipment replacement plan
	8. Audible and visible alarm systems for fridge malfunctioning
	9. Access to a Biomedical Engineer/ Technician
Equipment Calibration schedule (Fridges, weighing scales)	10. Availability of schedule, calibration done on schedule and calibration log sheet properly filled

WATER MANAGEMENT

Adequate water supply available	
	1. Easy to open taps
	2. Flowing water
	3. Adequate back up water supply

WASTE MANAGEMENT -THEATRE

1. Pedal-operated waste bins at the facility
2. Availability of appropriate colour-coded waste bin lining available in all areas. Red-Biohazard (mortuary waste); Black (General waste)
3. Availability of safety/sharps boxes in theatre
4. Protocol and procedures for prevention of spread of infectious diseases available.
5. Hand washing sinks with elbow/pedal/automatic tap and sanitizers available
6. Posters on appropriate hand-washing technique displayed
7. Procedure on decontamination and disinfection and storage of instrument (assess at least 1 staff - use Direct Staff Performance Assessment Tool)
8. Procedure for decontamination of soiled linens (assess at least 1 staff - use Direct Staff Performance Assessment Tool)
9. Cleaning schedule available (date, time, persons responsible and signed)
10. Access to incinerator (Appropriate location and stack height) /waste shredding/autoclave
11. *Treated Liquid Waste Disposal (Evidence of drainage to septic tanks, decontamination, no standing water for mosquito breeding, outsourced to liquid waste management company) White-rain/storm; Grey-Hand wash; Black W/c, etc., -Waste
12. Availability/evidence of access to accredited CSSD

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GENERAL WAITING AREA

General
1. Curtains/blinds
2. Pedal-Operated bins with appropriate colour coding
3. Appropriate bin liners (Yellow, Red and Black)
4. Adequate ventilation
5. Adequate illumination
6. Comfortable Seats

STAFF WASHROOM -THEATRE

a. Bathroom
1. Emergency shower
2. Flowing water
3. Towel bars
4. Pedal bin/black liners
5. Shower enclosure with clean walls and non-slip floors
6. Drainage

b. Toilet facility
1. Working Water Closet (at least one in each of the separate washrooms)
2. Sink, elbow tap and hand soap
3. Toilet roll
4. Pedal bins with appropriate bin liners in each stall
5. Pedal bin/black liners in hand wash area
6. Clean non-slip floors
7. Drainage

STAFF CHANGING ROOM

1. Adequate spacing
2. Well ventilated
3. Well illuminated
4. Personal effects lockers
5. Pedal operated bins
6. Garment collector (Laundry basket)
7. Hand washing facility and adjoining shower room
8. Seating facility for changing

AUTOPSY THEATRE

a. General Equipment	
1.	Autopsy table (stainless steel) - 1 table per 5 autopsies per day
2.	Full PPE – for all theatre staff/persons (e.g., police investigator)
3.	Trolleys with body tray
4.	Complete set of autopsy instruments (at least one)
5.	Other theatre equipment (weighing scale, metal measuring rule & jug, saw (manual and/ or electric)
6.	Cut resistance/Utility/Elbow length gloves
7.	Pedal operated waste bins
8.	String and sewing needles
b. Environmental issues	
9.	Unidirectional air flow (top to down) and extractors
10.	Lighting (including U.V. light)
11.	Drainage system and waste disposal
12.	Water supply system
13.	Sample labels, biohazard bags

SAFETY AND SECURITY

1.	Accessibility of the facility (including washrooms) to the disabled
2.	Limitation of movement within the facility (hazard zoning)
3.	Loading/offloading bay for bodies, hearse bay, walk-ways)
4.	Ease of navigation within the facility Availability of ramps for trolleys and equipment, wide passageways
5.	Availability of functional lifts/escalators/elevators, or ramps (for facilities with storey building/ multiple level rack systems).
6.	Parking area for hearse, Staff & General Public
7.	24-hour security (complete walled/barbed wire, gated, availability of security staff /surveillance system)
Fire safety	8.Functional and non-expired Fire Extinguishers (6kg dry powder, 3kg

systems	CO ₂)
	9.Fire/smoke detectors (select 3 areas)
	10.Availability of emergency assembly point, clearly labelled and evidence of training on fire fighting
	11. Availability of fire hydrant and or wet risers
Floors	12.Washable, No cracks & non-slip
	13.Clean (dry, no litter/no stains and odorless)
Power Supply	14.No loose/exposed wires, No loose sockets/switches & available back up supply
	15.Adequate Backup power supply (accepted by an approved energy expert as determined by power rating)
Intact roof and ceiling, door and window.	16.No gaps between wall and roof, No cracks & No cobwebs/ No mold
Walls	17. No stains & no cracks
Lighting	18. Well lit, all-around.
Laundry	19. On-site laundry for staff working clothing
Theatre & Cold storage area	20.Impervious walls and floors
	21.Washable and disinfectable
	22.Installed UV light (overnight disinfection)

a. General Equipment
1. Stainless steel table(s)/slab adequate number
2. Full PPE per embalmer
3. Trolleys with body tray
4. Body bags where available
5. Embalming Instruments and equipment (e.g., artery tubes, mortician pump, cavity injectors Trocar, embalming needle, etc.)
6. Pedal operated waste bins
b. Environmental issues
1. Drainage system and waste disposal
2. Vermin control

3. Lighting (including U.V. light)
4. Unidirectional air flow (top to down) and extractors
5. Water supply system

MORTUARY COLD STORAGE (where applicable)

Required temperature (4°C to 8°C) – temperature chart
Availability of appropriate storage space for human remains.
Storage capacity of refrigerator/cold room
Type and condition of refrigerator/cold room

